DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 14

Local SEO consultant

Profession 14 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A local SEO consultant helps local businesses appear in map results and nearby searches: business profiles, reviews, local content and consistent business details.

What professionals do every day

Claims and optimises business profiles, manages reviews and replies, checks citation consistency, builds local pages and reports on calls, directions and enquiries.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Most local customers search on a phone for 'near me' services. A consultant makes the business findable at the moment of need.

- Missing or incorrect business profiles.
- Reviews left unanswered.
- Inconsistent name, address and phone across the web.

Skills you need

- Google Business Profile setup and rules.
- Review management.
- Local keywords and location pages.
- Citation consistency.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Google Business Profile	Map listing and insights	Free	Free	business.google.com
Google Search Console	Local search performance	Free	Free	search.google.com/search-console
Moz Local	Citation management (verify plans)	Trial	Paid plans	moz.com/local
BrightLocal	Local SEO tracking (verify plans)	Trial	Paid plans	www.brightlocal.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Complete one business profile with photos, hours and services.

Intermediate	Reply to five reviews with a consistent tone.
Advanced	Check name, address and phone on five directories.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Local clinic profile.
- **Intermediate:** Restaurant map listing.
- **Advanced:** Plumber service-area pages.

Client-ready portfolio project

A local SEO plan for a fictional bakery: profile checklist, review reply templates, citation list and a 60-day plan.

Worked example

Worked example. The bakery's name appears as 'Asha's Bakery' on the map and 'Asha Bakery' on a directory. The consultant standardises the name everywhere and records the change.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Citation consistency check

Business problem: A bakery's details differ across the web.

Steps

1. List the official name, address and phone.
2. Check five directories and record every difference.
3. Correct each listing using the directory's own process.
4. Re-check after two weeks.

Expected output: A table of differences and fixes.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

One standard set of details is the reference. Every correction is recorded so the change can be explained later. The re-check confirms the directories updated.

Common mistakes

- Inconsistent details across listings.
- Fake or incentivised reviews.
- Keyword-stuffed business names.
- Ignoring the profile's questions and messages.

Freelancing opportunities

- Local SEO packages for clinics, restaurants and trades.
- Review management plans.
- Briefs for 'local SEO', 'Google Business Profile', 'map ranking'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Google Business Profile Help

Part of **Master Freelancing: Marketing**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full text book. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.